

Caregiver Burnout: Early Signs & Self-Care Checklist

A practical handout for family caregivers supporting someone through cancer or serious illness.

Possible warning signs

- Constant exhaustion even after rest
- Irritability, guilt, helplessness or emotional numbness
- Skipping meals, medication, sleep or medical appointments for yourself
- Feeling that you must do everything alone
- Loss of interest in usual activities or withdrawal from others

Protective actions

- Share tasks with family, friends or community supports where possible.
- Schedule brief non-negotiable rest periods, even 10-15 minutes.
- Keep one person informed about your own emotional state.
- Ask the medical team clear questions about what care is essential and what can be delegated.
- Seek counselling or professional support if stress is persistent or escalating.

A daily question

- Ask yourself: "What is one thing I need today to continue caring without losing myself?"

Gentle reminder

This guide is for psychoeducation and supportive self-care. It is not a substitute for medical, psychiatric, emergency or crisis care.